No. 15

COLLECTION

SELLERS

Sell
Pric

The 7-step

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BEFORE YOU BEGIN

Important notice

This guide is provided for informational and educational purposes only. It presents general information about real estate in Quebec and does not constitute personalized real estate, legal, tax or financial advice. Every real estate situation is different, and you should consult the appropriate professionals before making a decision about a transaction.

Selling at the Best Price

The 7-step game plan – from pricing to closing

Selling your property at the best price is not a stroke of luck: it is the result of a method. Good starting price, preparation, marketing, negotiation and follow-up until signing - every step counts.

This guide presents the 7-step game plan that a broker uses to maximize price and minimize stress. You will know what to do, in what order, and why.

Each chapter ends with a lined "My Notes" page to prepare YOUR sale.

Selling at the best price is not hoping for a miracle: it is taking seven mastered steps, from the right starting price to signing. This guide takes them through, with the mistakes to avoid at each phase.

The common thread: price and preparation weigh much more than luck. What you control at the start determines the end result.

CHAPTER

Steps 1-2: the right price and preparation

> *Get off to a good start: fair price and ready property.*

Step 1 - Set the right price

The starting price is the most strategic decision. Too high, the property stagnates, wears out on the market and ultimately sells for less; too low, we leave money on the table. The price is set based on a comparative market analysis (similar recent sales), not on a wish.

Step 2 - Prepare the property

- Declutter, deep clean, depersonalize.
- Minor repairs that are obvious (handles, joints, touch-ups).
- Light home staging to highlight spaces (see the dedicated guide).

The starting price is the decision with the most serious consequences: too high, the property stagnates and “burns”; just, it attracts quickly and can create emulation. Preparation (cleaning, decluttering, small repairs) then multiplies the effect of a good price.

> EMILIE'S ADVICE
>
> *A property that is overvalued at the start almost always sells for less in the end: it becomes “the one lying around”. The right price from day 1 creates the enthusiasm which drives up the offers.*

CHAPTER

Steps 3-4: marketing and visits

> *Expose the property to as many qualified buyers as possible.*

Step 3 - Market

- Professional photos, video, careful description (see the marketing guide).
- Wide distribution (Centris, networks, broker network).
- Complete and honest information sheet to attract the right buyers.

Step 4 - Manage visits

Facilitate visits (availability, constant cleanliness, absence of owners). Each visit is an opportunity: a house that is difficult to visit is a house that sells less well.

Marketing aims to expose the property to as many qualified buyers as possible: professional photos, careful description, wide distribution, well-organized visits. The first few weeks focus most of the interest - be flawless from day one online.

> EMILIE'S ADVICE
>
> *The first weeks are the most important: this is when interest is maximum. A well-prepared and well-priced property often creates its best deals early.*

CHAPTER

Steps 5-6: offers and negotiation

> *Transform interest into best accepted offer.*

An offer is evaluated as a whole: price, conditions, dates, solidity of the buyer's financing. The highest is not always the best if its conditions are fragile.

- Analyze each offer: price, conditions (inspection, financing), deadlines.
- Negotiate or make a counter-offer while keeping your objective in mind.
- In multiple offers, a structured strategy maximizes the result (see the dedicated guide).

An offer is evaluated as a whole: price, but also conditions, possession dates and solidity of financing. The best offer is not always the highest if it is fragile. Respond with the facts, stick to your strategy, and let your broker lead the negotiation.

> EMILIE'S ADVICE
>
> *Don't let yourself be dazzled by the number alone. A slightly lower but unconditional and well-financed offer is sometimes safer - and more profitable - than a high and flimsy offer.*

CHAPTER

Step 7: from acceptance to closing

> *Secure the sale until signature.*

An accepted offer is not a concluded sale: the conditions remain to be met (inspection, financing of the buyer, examination of documents). Good monitoring prevents the transaction from being derailed during this sensitive period.

- Facilitate inspection and access to requested documents.
- Provide the notary with the required documents (certificate of location, seller's declaration).
- Prepare your own move and hand over the keys.

An accepted offer is not a concluded sale: there remain the conditions to be met (inspection, financing) and the route to the notary. Stay available, provide documents quickly and anticipate the buyer's requests to prevent a condition from derailing the sale.

> EMILIE'S ADVICE
>
> *Stay collaborative during the lifting of conditions: a transaction that is well supported until the notary is a transaction that is completed. This is where a broker's experience makes the difference.*

CHAPTER

Sales mistakes to avoid

> *Do not sabotage your own sale.*

Certain very common errors cost the seller dearly:

- **Overestimate** the starting price: the property stagnates and “burns”.
- Neglect the **preparation** and photos.
- Return the **visits** difficult to organize.
- React to**emotion** rather than the facts in negotiation.

The good news: these errors are all avoidable with a little method and perspective.

Classic mistakes are costly: overestimating, neglecting preparation and photos, making visits difficult, or negotiating based on emotion. All are preventable with method. A fairly priced and well presented property often sells faster AND more expensive than an overpriced property that is lying around.

> EMILIE'S ADVICE
>
> *The first weeks on the market are the most valuable: this is when interest is maximum. Pricing too high at the start wastes this momentum, and a property that hangs around often ends up selling for less.*

IN PRACTICE

Action plan

> *Your next steps, concretely.*

This week

1. Have a comparative analysis prepared to set the right price.
2. Start decluttering and small repairs.

Within 30 days

1. Take professional photos and marketing.
2. Organize flexible and well-prepared visits.

Then

1. Analyze the offers with Emilie and secure the transaction up to the notary.

Before marketing

1. Have a comparative analysis established and set a fair price.
2. Prepare property (declutter, repair, clean) and schedule professional photos.

REFERENCES

Resources & glossary

- Comparative market analysis: similar recent sales used to set the price.
- Home staging: presentation of the property for sale.
- Marketing: photos, distribution and description to attract buyers.
- Lifting of conditions: period when the buyer validates inspection and financing.
- Closing: signature of the deed of sale at the notary.

- Starting price: key decision; too high, it causes leakage and “burns” the property.
- Comparative analysis: similar recent sales used to set the price.
- Days on market: display duration; extends when the price is too high.
- Release of conditions: stage where the buyer confirms inspection and financing.
- Home staging: preparing the property to maximize its appeal.

GO FURTHER

Quiz - test yourself

1. The most strategic decision of the sale is:

A) The color of the sign

B) The starting price

C) The date of the move

D) The name of the notary

2. A property overvalued at the start:

A) Sells more expensively

B) Often sells for less in the end

C) Sells faster

D) Has no impact

3. The price is set from:

A) From a wish

B) A comparative market analysis

C) From the initial purchase price

D) In the opinion of neighbors

4. The most important weeks are:

A) The latest

B) The first, when interest is maximum

C) None

D) Winter ones

5. An offer is evaluated:

A) On price alone

B) As a whole (price, conditions, dates, financing)

C) Random

D) On signature only

6. An accepted offer is:

A) A sale concluded

B) Still subject to lifting of conditions

C) Worthless

D) Final immediately

7. During the lifting of conditions, you must:

A) Ignore the buyer

B) Stay collaborative and facilitate access

C) Refuse inspection

D) Change price

8. Facilitating visits allows:

A) To sell less well

B) To expose the property to more buyers

C) Nothing

D) Avoid offers

Answers

1. B - The right price creates excitement (chap. 1).

2. B - She becomes “the one who hangs around” (chap. 1).

3. B - Comparables give value (chap. 1).

4. B - Interest peaks at launch (chap. 2).

5. B - The highest is not always the best (chap. 3).

6. B - Inspection, financing, documents remain to be collected (chap. 4).

7. B - Good monitoring avoids derailment (chap. 4).

8. B - A house that is easy to visit sells better (chap. 2).

Make informed decisions.
Choose with confidence.
Move forward without regret.

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